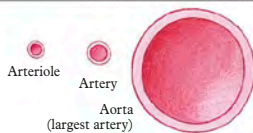




BLOOD



Blood is pumped all around your body by your heart. It travels in long tubes called blood vessels. Before it begins this journey, it is pushed to your lungs to collect oxygen. Then it returns to your heart to be pumped around your body. Blood also carries nutrients from your food to the cells.

Power pump

Your heart is made of strong muscle. In just one minute, it can pump a drop of blood all the way down to your toes and back to your heart again.

The heart is divided into four spaces called chambers, two at the top and two at the bottom. There is a wall of muscle down the middle.

Blood enters the top right chamber through the vena cava. It passes down to the bottom right chamber. Then it is pushed out to your lungs.

Blood, filled with oxygen from the lungs, comes into the top left chamber. It passes down to the bottom left chamber. Then it is pumped around your body.

After going around your body, the blood returns to the right side of your heart, to start the journey again.

Aorta

Flaps, called valves, stop blood from flowing the wrong way. It is the "lub-dub" sound of these doors closing that you hear when your heart beats.

